8.11 Addison's Disease and Adrenal Crisis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I feel weak and dizzy, and I vomit." **Objective** • BP 80/50 mmHg • Na^+ 128 mmol/L, K^+ 5.8 mmol/L • Hyperpigmentation	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to aldosterone and cortisol deficiency as evidenced by hypotension and hyponatremia.	• BP stable within 6 hours.	• Give IV hydrocortisone straight away, as prescribed. • Give IV saline and dextrose as ordered. • Follow vital signs, glucose and electrolytes.	• Met when BP is stable.
Subjective • "Why must I double my tablets when sick?" **Objective** • New diagnosis • Cannot explain sick-day rules	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to corticosteroid replacement as evidenced by questioning.	• Explains the sick-day rules.	• Teach that corticosteroids must never be stopped. • Teach how to increase the dose during illness, as instructed. • Advise carrying a steroid card and an emergency injection kit.	• Achieved when the rules are explained back.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Cortisol deficiency • Glucose 62 mg/dL on arrival	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: hypoglycemia associated with cortisol deficiency.	• Blood glucose stays within normal range.	• Check glucose. • Give dextrose as ordered. • Give hydrocortisone on time.	• Outcome reached if glucose remains normal.

*References for this care plan: [8], [32], [35], [128]. Full entries are listed in theFull entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.